

AccuKnox {vs} Prisma Cloud

AccuKnox vs Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition: CNAPP & Cloud Security Platform Comparison

Compare AccuKnox and Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition across ASPM, CSPM, KSPM, CWPP, DSPM and AI security. AccuKnox runs the full platform in your cloud, on-prem or air-gapped. It also ships native SAST, DAST and LLM security, which Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition does not include.

^{47,48,49,50}

Compared with Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition (SaaS), release 26.8.1. Compute Edition excluded.⁵¹

✔ Supported — Limited, partial or coming soon ✖ Not supported Superscripts link to the numbered sources.

Parameters



Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition

DEPLOYMENT MODELS

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SaaS (Regional / Sovereign)	✔ SaaS in US, EU, India, Middle East ¹	— 17 SaaS tenants incl. GovCloud, China ⁵²
Customer Cloud (BYOC)	✔ Control plane in your AWS, Azure or GCP ¹	✖ SaaS only. PAN runs the console ⁴⁷
On-Prem / Private Cloud	✔ Full control plane on-prem, all features but AskADA ²	— Defenders on-prem. Control plane SaaS only ⁵³
Air-Gapped Deployment	✔ ASPM, CSPM, CWPP, KSPM, GRC fully offline ¹	✖ Not in Enterprise Edition. Compute Edition only ⁴⁷

APPLICATION SECURITY

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SAST	✔ Pipeline and IDE SAST, AI false-positive triage ³	— No native scanner. Imports Veracode, SonarQube, SARIF ⁴⁸
DAST	✔ 4 scan types, incl. authenticated behind MFA ⁴	✖ No DAST. WAAS is runtime protection ⁴⁹
Code Quality (Best Practices)	✔ 2-engine SAST, 14 languages, SonarQube gates ⁵	— No code quality scanning documented ⁴⁹
IaC Scanning	✔ Terraform, CFN, ARM, Bicep, Helm, Ansible, CDK + 6 ⁶	✔ Terraform, OpenTofu, CFN, ARM, Bicep, Helm, Ansible + 7 ⁵⁴
Container Scanning	✔ CI/CD, registry, in-cluster, deploy blocking ⁷	✔ Registry, CI, agentless and twistcli scans ⁵⁵
Secrets (Repo / IaC)	✔ Repos, pipelines, IaC, correlated in ASPM ⁸	✔ VCS and CI/CD scans, Git history, validation ⁵⁶
Secrets in K8s ConfigMaps	✔ ConfigMaps and deployment manifests ⁹	— Repo files only. No in-cluster ConfigMap scan ⁵⁶
SARIF Ingestion	✔ Any tool: Checkmarx, JFrog, Gitleaks, Sonatype ¹⁰	✔ SARIF 2.0 and 2.1 via console or API ⁵⁷
Repo / CI/CD Integration	✔ GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket + 9 CI/CD platforms ¹¹	✔ 5 VCS + Jenkins, Actions, CircleCI, Azure ⁵⁸

SOFTWARE SUPPLY CHAIN

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SCA	✔ Dependency SCA with CVE and license checks ¹²	✔ SCA, license compliance, PR package fixes ⁵⁹
Generate & Ingest SBOMs	✔ CycloneDX out, CycloneDX or SPDX in ¹³	— CycloneDX 1.4 export. Ingestion not documented ⁶⁰
Track Vulnerable Components	✔ CVEs, licenses, outdated versions per component ¹²	✔ Packages with CVEs and top severity ⁵⁹
Continuous CVE Monitoring	✔ Live NVD feed, daily EPSS and CISA KEV ¹⁴	✔ Intelligence Stream, several updates daily ⁶¹

CLOUD SECURITY POSTURE

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AWS	✔ CSPM, CDR auto-fix, inventory, GovCloud ¹⁵	✔ CSPM, runtime security, DSPM ⁶²
Azure	✔ CSPM, org-level onboarding, CDR auto-fix ¹⁶	✔ CSPM, runtime security, DSPM ⁶²
GCP	✔ CSPM, CDR auto-fix, CIS GCP benchmarks ¹⁷	✔ CSPM, runtime security, DSPM ⁶²
Multi-Cloud Asset Inventory	✔ One inventory of accounts, assets, workloads ¹⁸	✔ AWS, Azure, GCP, OCI, Alibaba. 24h refresh SLA ⁶³
Private Cloud (OpenShift / Nutanix)	✔ OpenShift, Nutanix, VMware Tanzu enforcement ¹⁹	— OpenShift v4. Nutanix not listed ⁶⁴
Secrets in S3 / Filesystems	✔ S3, filesystems, Hugging Face datasets ²⁰	— Host and image filesystems. S3 undocumented ⁶⁵
Public S3 Detection + Auto-Fix	✔ CloudTrail detection, reverts bucket to private ²¹	✔ Config policy plus CLI auto-remediation ⁶⁶
Real-Time Cloud Event Automation	✔ Real-time CloudTrail alerts trigger remediation ²¹	— Audit events alert only, can lag hours. No CLI auto-fix ⁶⁶

WORKLOAD & KUBERNETES RUNTIME

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Host Protection (VM, Bare Metal)	✓ KubeArmor systemd mode on VMs, bare metal ²²	✓ Host Defenders, Linux and Windows ⁶⁷
Container & K8s Runtime	✓ Process, file, network enforcement + microsegmentation ²³	✓ Learned models, Alert, Prevent, Block rules ⁶⁸
Preemptive / Inline Blocking	✓ Kernel LSM stops a process before it runs ²⁴	✓ Prevent effect stops a disallowed process ⁶⁸
eBPF / Kernel Enforcement	✓ eBPF plus AppArmor, SELinux, BPF-LSM ²⁴	✗ User-space Defender. No eBPF in docs ⁶⁹
Process Allow / Deny	✓ Per-pod or per-host process policies ²³	✓ Allow and deny lists, Prevent or Block ⁶⁸
File Integrity Monitoring	✓ Monitors and blocks critical path changes ²⁵	✓ Host FIM. Container write Prevent by directory ⁷⁰
Workload Anomaly Detection	✓ Learns baseline, blocks deviations ²⁶	✓ 1h learning, 24h dry run, rule enforcement ⁶⁸
Fileless Malware Protection	✓ Allow-list blocks unknown processes ²⁶	— [confirm from Prisma Cloud docs]
Continuous Image Scanning	✓ Scheduled scans of running images ²⁷	✓ Registry, CI, deployed images, several times daily ⁶¹
Trusted Registry Enforcement	✓ KnoxGuard admission per cluster or namespace ²⁸	✓ Trusted Images, alert or block ⁷¹
K8s Misconfiguration	✓ Findings with fix steps and Jira tickets ²⁹	✓ CIS checks plus OPA admission rules ⁷²
K8s CIS Benchmarks	✓ Scheduled Helm-installed CIS scanner ³⁰	✓ CIS K8s, EKS, AKS, GKE, OpenShift ⁷³

KUBERNETES IDENTITY (KIEM)

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KIEM (K8s Entitlements)	✓ RBAC search, graph, 15 risk queries ³¹	— CIEM is cloud IAM only. No K8s RBAC ⁷⁴
Service Account Inventory	✓ Service accounts, roles, bindings per cluster ³¹	✗ No K8s identity inventory documented ⁷⁴
Over-Permission Detection	✓ Flags principals with excess privileges ³¹	✗ Cloud IAM only. K8s RBAC not documented ⁷⁵
Risky Bindings & Cluster-Admin	✓ Flags roles that modify workloads or read secrets ³¹	— Audit-event alerts. No binding analysis ⁷⁶
Stale K8s Entitlements	✓ Unused roles and orphan service accounts ³¹	✗ Cloud IAM only. K8s not documented ⁷⁴

API SECURITY

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North-South (NGINX Ingress)	✓ NGINX Ingress connector feeds API inventory ³²	— WAAS per app. No NGINX ingress integration ⁷⁷
TLS Classification at Ingress	✓ Inspects TLS, flags misconfigurations ³³	— Decrypts per endpoint. No TLS report ⁷⁸
Sensitive Data in APIs	✓ Request and response data classification ³⁴	✓ Flags card, PII and session data ⁷⁹
Shadow API Detection	✓ Traffic vs OpenAPI spec ³⁴	✓ Detects shadow APIs. OpenAPI import ⁸⁰
Zombie API Detection	✓ Zombie and orphan APIs vs spec ³⁴	— Last-seen dates only. No zombie detection ⁷⁹

DATA SECURITY (DSPM)

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Data Discovery	✓ S3, Blob, cloud and self-hosted DBs, Drive, Salesforce ³⁵	✓ AWS, Azure, GCP, Snowflake, M365, file shares ⁸¹
Data Classification	✓ 283 classes, PII, PHI, PCI, secrets, 62 country packs ³⁵	✓ Predefined and custom classifiers ⁸²
Data Access Verification	— Coming soon	✓ Read, Write, List, Manage and public access map ⁸³
Publicly Exposed Data	✓ Flags public buckets, CDR makes them private ²¹	✓ Public access flagged by risk rules ⁸³
Data Policy Controls	— Coming soon	✓ Built-in and custom risk rules, DDR alerts ⁸⁴

COMPLIANCE & REPORTING

Parity on 5

Compliance Frameworks	✓ 33+ frameworks, 42 versions, ISO, NIST, PCI, SOC 2 ^{36,37,38}	✓ 60+ standards for AWS, plus 4 clouds, custom ^{62,85}
Compliance Reports	✓ Audit-ready PDF, CSV, JSON ³⁷	✓ One-time or recurring, emailed ⁸⁶
Findings Reporting	✓ Deduplicated across CSPM, KSPM, ASPM, runtime ¹	✓ Alert, compliance and Command Center reports ⁸⁷
Audit Trail	✓ EventTrail logs who, when, result ³⁹	✓ 120-day platform audit log ⁸⁸
Findings Collaboration	✓ Jira, ServiceNow, Zendesk + 2, PDF/CSV/JSON ¹	✓ Jira, email, Slack, CSV, snooze ⁸⁹

AI SECURITY

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LLM Red Teaming	✓ Bedrock, Vertex AI, AI Foundry, Triton, vLLM ⁴⁰	✗ Not in Enterprise Edition. Sold as Prisma AIRS ⁵⁰
Prompt Firewall	✓ Inline: blocks, masks or logs prompts and responses ⁴¹	✗ Not in Enterprise Edition. Sold as Prisma AIRS ⁵⁰
ML Model Scanning	✓ Pickle, Keras H5, SavedModel, ONNX ⁴²	✗ Finds Hugging Face files. Scanning is AIRS ⁹⁰
OWASP LLM Top 10	✓ v2025 mapped in AI-SPM and red teaming ³⁶	— Posture findings mapped. No runtime control ⁹¹
AI/ML Runtime Sandboxing	✓ ModelArmor sandboxes models and agents ⁴³	— Generic runtime defense. No AI sandbox ⁶⁸
AI Model & Dataset Exposure	✓ Detects public endpoints, makes them private ⁴⁴	— Detects exposure. No blocking ⁹²
Unknown-Region Model Access	✓ Alerts outside allowed regions ²¹	— Generic UEBA location alerts ⁹³

INTEGRATIONS

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SIEM	✓ Splunk, Sentinel, QRadar, Sumo Logic, rsyslog ⁴⁵	✓ Splunk HEC, Security Lake, webhooks, SQS ⁹⁴
Bi-Directional Ticketing	✓ Ticket closes finding, recurrence reopens it ¹	— One-way push to Jira, ServiceNow ⁹⁵

Why Customers Choose AccuKnox Over Prisma Cloud



Better

AccuKnox secures code, cloud, Kubernetes, data and AI in one platform, mapped to 33+ compliance frameworks. Its runtime engine, KubeArmor, is a CNCF Sandbox project with 2 million+ downloads.^{1,37}



Faster

KubeArmor enforces policy inline at the kernel, so a disallowed process stops before it runs. At one of India's top 3 public sector banks, AccuKnox cut remediation time by 91% and false positives by 89%.^{24,46}



Affordable

One AccuKnox platform includes SAST, DAST, DSPM and AI security. Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition documents no native SAST or DAST, and Palo Alto Networks sells AI red teaming and prompt inspection separately as Prisma AIRS.^{48,50}

GET A LIVE TOUR

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Sources

Prisma Cloud facts come from Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition documentation at docs.prismacloud.io and from paloaltonetworks.com, read on 2026-09-30. AccuKnox facts come from help.accuknox.com and one published AccuKnox case study. A cell marked [confirm] had no public source when this was written. Palo Alto Networks offers Cortex Cloud as an upgrade for Prisma Cloud customers, and Cortex Cloud capabilities differ from this table.

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5. ACCUKNOX SAST support matrix

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17. ACCUKNOX GCP

18. ACCUKNOX Asset inventory

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27. ACCUKNOX In cluster image scan Helm

28. ACCUKNOX Admission controller KnoxGuard

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About AccuKnox

AccuKnox is a Zero Trust CNAPP Cloud Security protects Public clouds, Private clouds, Kubernetes, VMs, Bare metals, IoT Edge, and 5G security.



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